

National Digital Learning Policy for Higher Education — Main Policy

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Issued in 2026 by Higher Education Department under reference HEIRS/POL/2026/014, this main policy establishes the arrangements supporting National Digital Learning Policy for Higher Education. In scope are Digital Learning, Universities, Infrastructure, together with related expectations for institutions and stakeholders.

Context and Background

Stakeholders across Higher Education Department have emphasised the importance of Digital Learning as a foundation for credible, well-governed higher education. The present main policy responds to that expectation by setting out clear, practical direction.

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Purpose

The purpose of this document is to establish a consistent basis for Digital Learning, Universities across Higher Education Department-affiliated institutions, to clarify responsibilities, and to define the outcomes expected of every stakeholder.

By setting out the rationale, scope and operating expectations for Digital Learning, the document aims to reduce ambiguity, support institutional planning and improve the quality of Universities across the system.

Policy Objectives

This document seeks to enhance institutional capacity for Digital Learning, Universities, promote transparency in decision-making, and ensure that resources committed to related initiatives are used effectively.

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Scope and Applicability

Applicable across the full range of institutions governed by Higher Education Department, the document addresses planning, delivery, resourcing and evaluation, and may be supplemented by operational guidance issued subsequently.

The provisions apply to all universities and colleges under Higher Education Department. Sector partners, including employers and professional bodies, are expected to support implementation within their respective spheres.

Principal Provisions

Key provisions establish minimum standards for Digital Learning, define the responsibilities of institutional leadership, and require documented arrangements for Universities.

Institutions are required to integrate Digital Learning, Universities into annual planning cycles, designate accountable officers, and maintain records demonstrating compliance with the expectations set out here.

Implementation Framework

Implementation will proceed through phased institutional adoption, supported by professional development, shared guidance and a common reporting calendar established by Higher Education Department.

A dedicated implementation pathway, covering readiness assessment, capacity building and progressive rollout, has been designed to allow institutions of varying size and maturity to comply.

Accountability Framework

Heads of institutions bear overall responsibility for embedding Digital Learning, supported by designated coordinators, academic bodies and administrative units within each institution.

Higher Education Department provides policy direction, capacity support and performance oversight, while institutions translate the framework into operational practice and maintain day-to-day accountability.

Monitoring Arrangements

Monitoring covers both compliance and quality, combining documented evidence with stakeholder feedback to build a complete picture of institutional performance over time.

Closing Note

Effective implementation of National Digital Learning Policy for Higher Education will depend on sustained institutional commitment and close coordination between Higher Education Department and the sector. Institutions are encouraged to embed the arrangements described here into their normal planning and review cycles.